NITI AAYOG

2015 ORIGIN, LEGAL STATUS → MANDATE: THINK, CONVENE AND → COMPOSITION AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE ROLES → GOVERNING COUNCIL AND REGIONAL → PLANNING COMMISSION TRANSITION → COOPERATIVE AND COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 — 2015 ORIGIN, LEGAL STATUS AND POWER BOUNDARY

2015 ORIGIN, LEGAL STATUS AND POWER BOUNDARY · 1 JANUARY 2015 · UNION CABINET RESOLUTION CREATES NITI AAYOG · EXECUTIVE + NON-CONSTITUTIONAL + NON-STATUTORY · ADVISE, CONVENE, STRATEGISE, MONITOR AND SUPPORT CAPACITY · NO OWN POWER · LEGISLATE, TAX, ALLOCATE DIVISIBLE POOL OR IMPOSE STATE PLANS · RECOMMENDATION BECOMES ACTION ONLY THROUGH COMPETENT GOVERNMENT AUTHORITY.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- 1 JANUARY 2015 → Union Cabinet resolution creates NITI Aayog
- STATUS → executive + non-constitutional + non-statutory

POWER / PROCEDURE
- ROLE → advise, convene, strategise, monitor and support capacity
- NO OWN POWER → legislate, tax, allocate divisible pool or impose State plans

CHECK / LIMIT
- LIMIT: recommendation becomes action only through competent government authority.
- MUST REMEMBER: NITI Aayog is an executive, non-constitutional and non-statutory policy platform created by the Cabinet resolution of 1 January 2015.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- 1 JANUARY 2015 → Union Cabinet resolution creates NITI Aayog
- STATUS → executive + non-constitutional + non-statutory

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: NITI Aayog is an executive, non-constitutional and non-statutory policy platform created by the Cabinet resolution of 1 January 2015.

01 — MANDATE: THINK, CONVENE AND LEARN

THINK, CONVENE AND LEARN · STRATEGY, POLICY RESEARCH AND KNOWLEDGE NETWORKS · UNION-STATE DIALOGUE AND INTER-SECTOR COORDINATION · MONITORING, EVALUATION, FEEDBACK AND ADAPTATION · SHARED VISION + BOTTOM-UP PLANS + VULNERABLE GROUPS + AN OFFICIAL OBJECTIVE IS A MANDATE, NOT EVIDENCE OF

THINK → strategy, policy research and knowledge networks → CONVENE → Union-State dialogue and inter-sector coordination → LEARN → monitoring, evaluation, feedback and adaptation → FOUNDATION → shared vision + bottom-up plans + vulnerable groups + technology → TRAP: an official objective is a mandate, not evidence of achieved outcomes.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- THINK → strategy, policy research and knowledge networks
- CONVENE → Union-State dialogue and inter-sector coordination

POWER / PROCEDURE
- LEARN → monitoring, evaluation, feedback and adaptation
- FOUNDATION → shared vision + bottom-up plans + vulnerable groups + technology

CHECK / LIMIT
- TRAP: an official objective is a mandate, not evidence of achieved outcomes.
- THINK → strategy, policy research and knowledge networks

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- CONVENE → Union-State dialogue and inter-sector coordination
- LEARN → monitoring, evaluation, feedback and adaptation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: an official objective is a mandate, not evidence of achieved outcomes.

02 — COMPOSITION AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE ROLES

COMPOSITION AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE ROLES · PRIME MINISTER · GOVERNING COUNCIL · STATE CMs + RELEVANT UT LEADERSHIP · EXPERT SIDE · VICE-CHAIRPERSON + FULL-TIME AND PART-TIME MEMBERS · UNION LINK · EX-OFFICIO MINISTERS + SPECIAL INVITEES · CHAIRPERSON → Prime Minister

GOVERNING COUNCIL → State CMs + relevant UT leadership → EXPERT SIDE → Vice-Chairperson + full-time and part-time members → UNION LINK → ex-officio Ministers + special invitees

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- CHAIRPERSON → Prime Minister
- GOVERNING COUNCIL → State CMs + relevant UT leadership
- EXPERT SIDE → Vice-Chairperson + full-time and part-time members
- UNION LINK → ex-officio Ministers + special invitees

POWER / PROCEDURE
- ADMINISTRATION → CEO
- CONTROL: names, portfolios and invitees require a dated official notification.
- LATEST FORMAL ROSTER: 24 APRIL 2026
- Vice Chairperson: Ashok Kumar Lahiri.

CHECK / LIMIT
- Full-time: Rajiv Gauba
- K. V. Raju
- Gobardhan Das
- Abhay Karandikar

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- M. Srinivas.
- Ex-officio members and special invitees remain those in the 16 July 2024 notice.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ex-officio members and special invitees remain those in the 16 July 2024 notice.

03 — GOVERNING COUNCIL AND REGIONAL COUNCILS

GOVERNING COUNCIL AND REGIONAL COUNCILS · GOVERNING COUNCIL · CONTINUING PM-CHAIRED DEVELOPMENT-POLICY FORUM · STATE AND UT POLITICAL LEADERSHIP UNDER CURRENT CONSTITUTION/ORDER · REGIONAL COUNCIL · TEMPORARY, ISSUE-SPECIFIC, MULTI-STATE OR REGIONAL MECHANISM · JOINT DIAGNOSIS · AGREED FOLLOW-UP · GOVERNING COUNCIL → continuing PM-chaired development-policy forum

MEMBERS → State and UT political leadership under current constitution/order → REGIONAL COUNCIL → temporary, issue-specific, multi-State or regional mechanism → PROCESS → agenda → joint diagnosis → consultation → agreed follow-up

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- GOVERNING COUNCIL → continuing PM-chaired development-policy forum
- MEMBERS → State and UT political leadership under current constitution/order

POWER / PROCEDURE
- REGIONAL COUNCIL → temporary, issue-specific, multi-State or regional mechanism
- PROCESS → agenda → joint diagnosis → consultation → agreed follow-up

CHECK / LIMIT
- LIMIT: consensus is political coordination, not binding law or a State veto.
- GOVERNING COUNCIL → continuing PM-chaired development-policy forum

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- MEMBERS → State and UT political leadership under current constitution/order
- REGIONAL COUNCIL → temporary, issue-specific, multi-State or regional mechanism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: consensus is political coordination, not binding law or a State veto.

04 — PLANNING COMMISSION TRANSITION

PLANNING COMMISSION TRANSITION · BOTH BODIES AROSE THROUGH EXECUTIVE RESOLUTION · PLANNING COMMISSION · FIVE-YEAR PLANS + PLAN-RESOURCE INFLUENCE + CENTRAL NEGOTIATION · INDICATIVE STRATEGY + FEDERAL DIALOGUE + MONITORING + KNOWLEDGE · LATER REFORM · PLAN/NON-PLAN BUDGET DISTINCTION ENDED SEPARATELY · DIRECTIVE ALLOCATION SHIFTED TOWARD ADVISORY COORDINATION AND SOFTER LEVERAGE.

CONTINUITY → both bodies arose through executive resolution → PLANNING COMMISSION → Five-Year Plans + plan-resource influence + central negotiation → NITI → indicative strategy + federal dialogue + monitoring + knowledge → LATER REFORM → plan/non-plan budget distinction ended separately → VERDICT: directive allocation shifted toward advisory coordination and softer leverage.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- CONTINUITY → both bodies arose through executive resolution
- PLANNING COMMISSION → Five-Year Plans + plan-resource influence + central negotiation

POWER / PROCEDURE
- NITI → indicative strategy + federal dialogue + monitoring + knowledge
- LATER REFORM → plan/non-plan budget distinction ended separately

CHECK / LIMIT
- VERDICT: directive allocation shifted toward advisory coordination and softer leverage.
- CONTINUITY → both bodies arose through executive resolution

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- PLANNING COMMISSION → Five-Year Plans + plan-resource influence + central negotiation
- NITI → indicative strategy + federal dialogue + monitoring + knowledge

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: directive allocation shifted toward advisory coordination and softer leverage.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: directive allocation shifted toward advisory coordination and softer leverage.

05 — COOPERATIVE AND COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM

COOPERATIVE AND COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM · SHARED AGENDA + STATE VOICE + JOINT PROBLEM-SOLVING + · COMMON INDICATOR · ADMINISTRATIVE RESPONSE · STATE SUPPORT · POLICY AND INSTITUTIONAL CAPABILITY PARTNERSHIPS · CENTRAL AGENDA POWER + BOYCOTT/NON-ATTENDANCE + UNEQUAL CAPACITY + · PARTICIPATION IMPROVES LEGITIMACY ONLY WHEN EVIDENCE AND FOLLOW-UP ARE

COOPERATIVE → shared agenda + State voice + joint problem-solving + capacity support → COMPETITIVE → common indicator → comparison → reputation → administrative response → STATE SUPPORT → policy and institutional capability partnerships → RISKS → central agenda power + boycott/non-attendance + unequal capacity + data gaming → BALANCE: participation improves legitimacy only when evidence and follow-up are credible.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- COOPERATIVE → shared agenda + State voice + joint problem-solving + capacity support
- COMPETITIVE → common indicator → comparison → reputation → administrative response

POWER / PROCEDURE
- STATE SUPPORT → policy and institutional capability partnerships
- RISKS → central agenda power + boycott/non-attendance + unequal capacity + data gaming

CHECK / LIMIT
- BALANCE: participation improves legitimacy only when evidence and follow-up are credible.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Advice, convening, monitoring and rankings do not confer legislative, taxing, devolution, fund-allocation or implementation powers.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- COOPERATIVE → shared agenda + State voice + joint problem-solving + capacity support
- COMPETITIVE → common indicator → comparison → reputation → administrative response

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Advice, convening, monitoring and rankings do not confer legislative, taxing, devolution, fund-allocation or implementation powers.

06 — EVIDENCE, INDICATORS AND EVALUATION

EVIDENCE, INDICATORS AND EVALUATION · VERIFIED DATA · MONITORING AND EVALUATION SUPPORT · SAFE REPORTING · RANK + ABSOLUTE LEVEL + CHANGE + UNCERTAINTY + · DASHBOARD MOVEMENT DOES NOT BY ITSELF ESTABLISH CAUSATION OR · OUTCOME → indicator → baseline → verified data → comparison

diagnosis → intervention → reassessment → DMEO → monitoring and evaluation support → SAFE REPORTING → rank + absolute level + change + uncertainty + field evidence

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- OUTCOME → indicator → baseline → verified data → comparison
- diagnosis → intervention → reassessment

POWER / PROCEDURE
- DMEO → monitoring and evaluation support
- SAFE REPORTING → rank + absolute level + change + uncertainty + field evidence

CHECK / LIMIT
- TRAP: dashboard movement does not by itself establish causation or durable welfare gain.
- OUTCOME → indicator → baseline → verified data → comparison

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- diagnosis → intervention → reassessment
- DMEO → monitoring and evaluation support

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: dashboard movement does not by itself establish causation or durable welfare gain.

07 — ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS AND BLOCKS

ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS AND BLOCKS · ALIGN SCHEMES AND AGENCIES · CENTRE + STATE + DISTRICT/BLOCK TEAMS · DELTA INDICATORS AND PEER COMPARISON · REMAINS WITH COMPETENT GOVERNMENTS AND FIELD ADMINISTRATION · NITI COORDINATES AND MONITORS; IT DOES NOT DIRECTLY DELIVER · CONVERGENCE → align schemes and agencies

COLLABORATION → Centre + State + district/block teams → COMPETITION → delta indicators and peer comparison → DELIVERY → remains with competent governments and field administration

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- CONVERGENCE → align schemes and agencies
- COLLABORATION → Centre + State + district/block teams

POWER / PROCEDURE
- COMPETITION → delta indicators and peer comparison
- DELIVERY → remains with competent governments and field administration

CHECK / LIMIT
- LIMIT: NITI coordinates and monitors; it does not directly deliver every service.
- CONVERGENCE → align schemes and agencies

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- COLLABORATION → Centre + State + district/block teams
- COMPETITION → delta indicators and peer comparison

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: NITI coordinates and monitors; it does not directly deliver every service.

08 — SDGS, DMEO AND ATAL INNOVATION MISSION

SDGS, DMEO AND ATAL INNOVATION MISSION · SDG LOCALISATION · STATE/LOCAL ATTENTION · PROGRAMME MONITORING AND EVALUATION · INNOVATION INITIATIVE UNDER NITI; ARCHITECTURE IS DATE-SENSITIVE · PROGRAMME TEST · OWNER + MECHANISM + IMPLEMENTER + EVIDENCE + LIMIT · PYQ 2019 · SDG LOCALISATION → goals → indicators → State/local attention

DMEO → programme monitoring and evaluation → AIM → innovation initiative under NITI; architecture is date-sensitive → PROGRAMME TEST → owner + mechanism + implementer + evidence + limit

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- SDG LOCALISATION → goals → indicators → State/local attention
- DMEO → programme monitoring and evaluation

POWER / PROCEDURE
- AIM → innovation initiative under NITI; architecture is date-sensitive
- PROGRAMME TEST → owner + mechanism + implementer + evidence + limit

CHECK / LIMIT
- PYQ 2019: institutional ownership matters more than the programme name.
- SDG LOCALISATION → goals → indicators → State/local attention

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- DMEO → programme monitoring and evaluation
- AIM → innovation initiative under NITI; architecture is date-sensitive

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PYQ 2019: institutional ownership matters more than the programme name.

09 — NITI AND NEIGHBOURING INSTITUTIONS

NITI AND NEIGHBOURING INSTITUTIONS · EXECUTIVE STRATEGY, DIALOGUE AND MONITORING · FINANCE COMMISSION · ARTICLE 280 FISCAL RECOMMENDATIONS · GST COUNCIL · ARTICLE 279A GST RECOMMENDATIONS · INTER-STATE COUNCIL · ARTICLE 263 COORDINATION ROUTE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring	GST COUNCIL → Article 279A GST recommendations	ZONAL COUNCILS → statutory regional cooperation	Never transfer one body's source or power to another.
FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280 fiscal recommendations	INTER-STATE COUNCIL → Article 263 coordination route	STATE FINANCE COMMISSIONS → State-local fiscal recommendations	NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring
- FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280 fiscal recommendations

POWER / PROCEDURE
- GST COUNCIL → Article 279A GST recommendations
- INTER-STATE COUNCIL → Article 263 coordination route

CHECK / LIMIT
- ZONAL COUNCILS → statutory regional cooperation
- STATE FINANCE COMMISSIONS → State-local fiscal recommendations

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Never transfer one body's source or power to another.
- NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Never transfer one body's source or power to another.

10 — STRENGTHS, DEFICITS AND ACCOUNTABLE REFORM

STRENGTHS, DEFICITS AND ACCOUNTABLE REFORM · FLEXIBILITY + EXPERTISE + CONVENING + CROSS-SECTOR EVIDENCE · NON-BINDING ADVICE + CENTRAL AGENDA + WEAK REPORTING + · STATE AGENDA WINDOWS + PUBLISHED CONSULTATIONS + INDEPENDENT DATA · ACTION TRACKING + PARLIAMENTARY VISIBILITY + IMPLEMENTATION FEEDBACK · RETAIN FLEXIBILITY WHILE MAKING INFLUENCE TRANSPARENT AND EVALUABLE.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
STRENGTHS → flexibility + expertise + convening + cross-sector evidence	REFORM → State agenda windows + published consultations + independent data audit	GOAL: retain flexibility while making influence transparent and evaluable.	DEFICITS → non-binding advice + central agenda + weak reporting + data risk
DEFICITS → non-binding advice + central agenda + weak reporting + data risk	action tracking + parliamentary visibility + implementation feedback	STRENGTHS → flexibility + expertise + convening + cross-sector evidence	REFORM → State agenda windows + published consultations + independent data audit

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- STRENGTHS → flexibility + expertise + convening + cross-sector evidence
- DEFICITS → non-binding advice + central agenda + weak reporting + data risk

POWER / PROCEDURE
- REFORM → State agenda windows + published consultations + independent data audit
- action tracking + parliamentary visibility + implementation feedback

CHECK / LIMIT
- GOAL: retain flexibility while making influence transparent and evaluable.
- STRENGTHS → flexibility + expertise + convening + cross-sector evidence

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- DEFICITS → non-binding advice + central agenda + weak reporting + data risk
- REFORM → State agenda windows + published consultations + independent data audit

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GOAL: retain flexibility while making influence transparent and evaluable.

11 — PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS · PYQ 2018 · NITI PRINCIPLES VERSUS PLANNING COMMISSION · PYQ 2019 · ATAL INNOVATION MISSION INSTITUTIONAL LOCATION · FEDERAL MECHANISM · PROGRAMME EVIDENCE · FISCAL/DATA LIMITS

PYQ 2018 → NITI principles versus Planning Commission → PYQ 2019 → Atal Innovation Mission institutional location → PRELIMS → executive != unconstitutional → Council != legislature → Index != power

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PYQ 2018 → NITI principles versus Planning Commission
- PYQ 2019 → Atal Innovation Mission institutional location
- PRELIMS → executive != unconstitutional

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Council != legislature
- Index != power
- MAINS → origin → mandate → composition → federal mechanism → programme evidence

CHECK / LIMIT
- fiscal/data limits → accountable reform → qualified verdict
- NITI succeeds through credible persuasion, State ownership and implementation.
- LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: The 24 April 2026 Gazette replaced the Vice Chairperson and

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- full-time member roster while retaining the July 2024 ex-officio members and invitees.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: fiscal/data limits → accountable reform → qualified verdict.

E — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

EXTRA · OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT! · INSTITUTIONAL ENRICHMENT! · [ANALYSIS] THE KEY DESIGN TRADE-OFF IS FLEXIBILITY VERSUS ACCOUNTABLE · EXECUTIVE STATUS · PERMITS RAPID ADAPTATION BUT WEAKENS MANDATORY REPORTING AND STABLE · [ANALYSIS] COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM WORKS ONLY WHEN INDICATORS ARE COMPARABLE · [LIMIT] STATE PARTICIPATION IN THE GOVERNING COUNCIL DOES NOT · [LIMIT] PROGRAMME OWNERSHIP, INDEX EDITIONS AND MEETING THEMES ARE

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE
- Institutional enrichment.
- [ANALYSIS] The key design trade-off is flexibility versus accountable permanence: executive status
- permits rapid adaptation but weakens mandatory reporting and stable intergovernmental procedure.

ADVANCED LIMIT
- [ANALYSIS] Competitive federalism works only when indicators are comparable, auditable and paired with absolute levels and field evidence.
- [LIMIT] State participation in the Governing Council does not create a State veto, binding compact or second federal chamber.
- [LIMIT] Programme ownership, index editions and meeting themes are dated evidence of institutional activity, not proof of outcomes.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- Institutional enrichment - [ANALYSIS] The key design trade-off is flexibility versus accountable permanence:
- executive status permits rapid adaptation but weakens mandatory reporting and stable intergovernmental procedure.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels